



Prepare business documents

D1.HGE.CL7.09

D1.HGA.CL6.06

D2.TGA.CL6.09

Assessor Manual



Prepare business documents

D1.HGE.CL7.09

D1.HGA.CL6.06

D2.TGA.CL6.09

Assessor Manual



Project Base

William Angliss Institute of TAFE

555 La Trobe Street

Melbourne 3000 Victoria

Telephone: (03) 9606 2111

Facsimile: (03) 9670 1330

Acknowledgements

Project Director: Wayne Crosbie

Project Manager: Jim Irwin

Chief Writer: Alan Hickman

Subject Writer: Alan Hickman

Editor: Jim Irwin

DTP/Production: Daniel Chee, Mai Vu, Cindy Curran

The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was established on 8 August 1967. The Member States of the Association are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Viet Nam.

The ASEAN Secretariat is based in Jakarta, Indonesia.

General Information on ASEAN appears online at the ASEAN Website: www.asean.org.

All text is produced by William Angliss Institute of TAFE for the ASEAN Project on "Toolbox Development for Front Office, Food and Beverage Services and Food Production Divisions".

This publication is supported by the Australian Government's aid program through the ASEAN-Australia Development Cooperation Program Phase II (AADCP II).

Copyright: Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) 2015.

All rights reserved.

Disclaimer

Every effort has been made to ensure that this publication is free from errors or omissions. However, you should conduct your own enquiries and seek professional advice before relying on any fact, statement or matter contained in this book. The ASEAN Secretariat and William Angliss Institute of TAFE are not responsible for any injury, loss or damage as a result of material included or omitted from this course. Information in this module is current at the time of publication. Time of publication is indicated in the date stamp at the bottom of each page.

Some images appearing in this resource have been purchased from stock photography suppliers Shutterstock and iStockphoto and other third party copyright owners and as such are non-transferable and non-exclusive. Clip arts, font images and illustrations used are from the Microsoft Office Clip Art and Media Library. Some images have been provided by and are the property of William Angliss Institute.

Additional images have been sourced from Flickr and SXC and are used under Creative Commons licence: <http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/2.0/deed.en>

File name: AM_Prepare_business_documents_150115

Table of contents

Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors.....	1
Competency standard.....	11
Oral questions.....	19
Written questions	27
Answers to written questions	39
Observation checklist.....	51
Third Party Statement.....	55
Competency recording sheet	57

Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: PREPARE BUSINESS DOCUMENTS		NOMINAL HOURS: 30
UNIT NUMBER: D1.HGE.CL7.09 D1.HGA.CL6.06 D2.TGA.CL6.09		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to prepare business documents in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1. Determine document requirements 1.1 Define clearly the requirements for <i>documents</i> including purpose, <i>audience</i>, <i>format</i>, <i>style</i>, content and scope in consultation with relevant others 1.2 Obtain <i>specialist assistance</i>, where appropriate, within budget parameters Element 2. Conduct research 2.1 Conduct <i>research</i> according to the requirements of the document, using informal and formal data collection methods as appropriate 2.2 Analyse and assess data for relevance prior to incorporation into document, identifying key issues Element 3. Prepare document 3.1 Write the document, using a suitable format, structure and style in accordance with requirements 3.2 Select and use appropriate <i>technology</i> and software for the requirements		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment This unit applies to all industry sectors that prepare business documents within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Food and Beverage Service 2. Food Production 3. Front Office 4. Housekeeping 5. Travel Agencies 6. Tour Operation <i>Documents</i> might include: • Reports • Newsletters

3.3 Use a range of <i>written presentation and graphic techniques</i> to enhance the impact and effectiveness of the information presented 3.4 Use language and style appropriate to the document and intended audience, ensuring clarity of information and ease of reading 3.5 Make recommendations for action where appropriate 3.6 Review and check <i>document presentation</i> prior to finalisation to ensure it is accurate, free from spelling and typing errors, and meets all requirements 3.7 Adjust where necessary, and seek advice or comment from relevant others, where appropriate 3.8 Publish the document in a format and style appropriate for the intended audience and purpose, and according to enterprise guidelines	• Submissions • Proposals • Project reviews • Web pages • Client data bases • Tenders • Complex letters • Project briefs • Business and operational plans.
Element 4. Follow up document 4.1 Present and circulate documents for comment as appropriate 4.2 Respond to any feedback and comments received, and adjust document where required 4.3 Submit document to <i>relevant persons</i> as appropriate 4.4 Maintain and file copies of all documents within a secure and ordered system, according to enterprise practices	<i>Audience</i> may relate to: • Colleagues • Customers • Government or business personnel • Legal or professional bodies • The general public. <i>Format</i> may relate to: • Purpose, audience and enterprise practices. <i>Style</i> may relate to: • Being formal • Being informal • Being dictated by house style and/or organisational style guides.

	<i>Specialist assistance</i> may refer to: • Facts and information, e.g. Copy writer, journalist, researcher • Instructions or designs, e.g. Graphic designer, instructional designer • Legal or financial advice, e.g. Solicitor, accountant. <i>Research</i> may relate to: • Interviews and focus groups • Conferences and seminars • Library research • Researching statistics, reports, or other business, or government documents • Internet search • Review of catalogues, brochures, industry journals, etc. • Surveys and questionnaires • Market research. <i>Technology</i> may include: • Computers • Modems • Scanners • Photocopiers • Printers. <i>Written presentations</i> may include: • Font style • Font size
--	---

	• Headings • Layout • Use of space • Use of italics, bold, underline • Use of dot points, numbers and other graphic devices. <i>Graphic techniques</i> to be used may include • Photographs • Drawings • Maps • Diagrams • Illustrations • Cartoons • Graphs and charts. <i>Document presentation</i> relates to: • Use of tables of content, divider sheets, footnotes, end notes, appendices and other literary conventions • Use of enterprise stationery • Type of bindings, e.g. Ring binder, spiral bound, wire bound, stapled or clipped • Covers and coversheets • Paper type and weight • Illustrations • Pagination • Logos, copyright information.
--	---

Relevant persons may include:

- Supervisors and managers
- External organisations, including marketing/advertising companies
- Government agencies
- Co-workers
- Sponsors
- Clients.

Assessment Guide

The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:

- Ability to use research skills, including accessing research outside the immediate experience and expertise of the individual
- Knowledge of academic research conventions
- Knowledge of current business practices related to preparing and presenting documents, including report formats, structures and styles for commonly-used business documents
- Familiarity with enterprise requirements for document design
- Knowledge of design, layout and graphic presentation techniques for business documents
- Ability to use proof reading and editing skills.

Linkages To Other Units

- Perform clerical procedures
- Access and retrieve computer-based data
- Produce documents, reports and worksheets on a computer

	• Use common business tools and technology • Gather and present product information • Plan, manage and conduct meetings • Develop and implement operational plans • Read and write English at a supervisory level. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Demonstrated understanding of organisational policies and procedures relating to preparing business documents • Demonstrated ability to use established research methods to identify sources of information and use such information to prepare business documents • Demonstrated ability to prepare business documents which express ideas and concepts that are clear, concise and correct • Demonstrated ability to develop a range of business documents commonly used in the relevant sector of the travel and hotel industries, within enterprise accepted timelines • Demonstrated ability to adapt tone, format, style and language, according to purpose and audience • Demonstrated ability to use current software and technology to prepare business documents. Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area, job role and area of responsibility • Assessment activities that require the candidate to research information and prepare business documents.
--	---

Resource Implications

Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace, current software and technology that provides the candidate with an opportunity to demonstrate application of knowledge of enterprise processes and procedures related to preparing business documents; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and current data and regulations.

Assessment Methods

The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:

- Case studies
- Observation of practical candidate performance
- Oral and written questions
- Portfolio evidence
- Problem solving
- Third party reports completed by a supervisor
- Project and assignment work.

Key Competencies in this Unit

Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively

Level 2 = competence to manage tasks

Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating

	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Research and analyse information; organise material for inclusion in the document
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Write clearly and concisely for a range of purposes and audiences
	Planning and organising activities	2	Plan and organise research methods and activities; plan the production of documents
	Working with others and in teams	2	Consult with other colleagues and customers about issues; conduct research interviews and focus groups
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	0	
	Solving problems	2	Edit and proof read documents to ensure inaccuracies are picked up before distribution
	Using technology	2	Select and use suitable software for particular documents; keyboard format and use software to present documents; distribute documents by email or Internet

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Prepare business documents D1.HGE.CL7.09 D1.HGA.CL6.06 D2.TGA.CL6.09
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Identify and differentiate between the purposes of three different business documents.	☐	☐
2. Explain (with reference to examples) why it is necessary to define the requirements of documents prior to preparing/writing them.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Give an example of how you might determine budget parameters relevant to the preparation, writing or production of a business document.	☐	☐
4. Explain how formal research might be undertaken to help gather data/facts for a business document to be produced/written.	☐	☐
5. What informal research could be used to help determine the facts/requirements for a business document which you have to prepare?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What might you do in order to analyse and assess data for relevance prior to incorporating that data into a business document you are going to produce?	☐	☐
7. Name two types of business documents and for each identify and justify a suitable format, structure and style.	☐	☐
8. What factors impact your selection of technology and software when producing business documents?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. Name and explain the uses of two other items apart from computers/word processors which you have used to complete the production of business documents in readiness for distribution and filing.	☐	☐
10. Tell me of instances where you have used a range of written presentation techniques to enhance the impact and effectiveness of information in a business document you have produced.	☐	☐
11. Give me three examples of where you have used a range of graphic presentation techniques to enhance the impact and effectiveness of information in a business document you have produced.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Give me an example of you might vary/adjust language in a business document so it clear and easy to read for a specific audience.	☐	☐
13. Tell me how you might vary the style of a business document so it best suits a nominated audience.	☐	☐
14. What 'recommendations for action' have you made to management when preparing business documents? Why and how did you make these suggestions?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. Explain what you do when you review and check draft business documents prior to releasing them for proofing/feedback.	☐	☐
16. What are you looking for when reviewing and checking draft business documents prior to releasing them for proofing/feedback?	☐	☐
17. Give me an example of two situations where you have had to adjust a document as part of the preparation/writing process based on your own knowledge of the requirements of the document, internal protocols and/or other relevant factors.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. Tell me what you do to publish for distribution a business document which has been approved by management for release.	☐	☐
19. Identify three different types of business documents you have produced and explain for each what is involved in circulating each to their intended target audience.	☐	☐
20. Give me an example of two occasions where you have had to adjust a draft business document on the basis of feedback/comment from others. What did you need to do and why?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
21. Tell me of three different ways you have released a business document to an external party.	☐	☐
22. What do you do to maintain and file copies of business documents you produce?	☐	☐

Written questions

Prepare business documents –D1.HGE.CL7.09 D1.HGA.CL6.06 D2.TGA.CL6.09

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. List three examples of business documents which may need to be produced.

2. Explain the influence 'the audience' should have on the document produced.

3. Name four factors which could influence the format of a business document.

4. What is an organisational 'Style Guide'?

5. What are two aspects of 'fonts' which need to be considered when determining document requirements?

6. Identify the 'styles' for each of the following letters:



7. Describe three types of assistance those who produce business documents may obtain from copy writers and journalists.

8. Identify three classifications of people (apart from copy writers and journalists) from whom assistance may be sought by those who produce business documents.

9. Describe four ways 'budget parameters' may/should impact the production of business documents.

10. Give four reasons research may need to occur before a business document is written.

11. Differentiate between 'formal' and 'informal' research.

12. Give four examples of research methods which might be used for business documents.

13. What is the difference between 'hard' research data and 'soft' research data'?

14. Differentiate between 'secondary research data' and 'primary research data'.

15. List four activities that may be involved in the 'analysis and assessment' of research data.

16. Name the four basic requirements that all research data used in business documents must comply with.

17. Give examples of four things which should be ensured when identifying the key issues as they apply to a document being prepared.

18. Identify and differentiate between the four text alignment/justification options.

19. Identify four features of 'headers' and 'footers' which need to be determined when clarifying format requirements of a document.

20. With reference to a letter, what is 'the closure'?

21. What are the four standard sections of a short report?

22. What are the five basic software packages which exist?

23. What is the role of a 'modem'?

24. Give four basic text options when producing a business document.

25. Give four examples of 'dot points'.

26. List four reasons graphics might be used in a business document.

27. Name four examples of graphics.

28. List three important points to bear in mind when considering 'audiences' in the production of business documents.

29. Approximately how many words should be in a sentence in a business document, and how many lines should there be in a paragraph?

30. Give four examples of when/where there is/may be a need for the producer of a business document to make suggestions for changes.

31. What are the 'Seven C's in relation to the writing of business documents?

32. What does TOC stand for?

33. What is the role of a 'divider sheet'?

34. Explain the difference between 'Footnotes' and 'End Notes'?

35. Are 'Appendices' placed at the front or back of a document?

36. List three ways documents may be bound or 'held together'.

37. Which paper size is twice the size of A4?

38. How many sheets of paper in a ream?

39. What is the gsm rating/number for commonly used office paper?

40. List three reasons adjustments may need to made to business documents.

41. What are the two generic ways of publishing a document?

42. What is meant by 'collating' a document?

43. What is the role of a 'Distribution List'?

44. Identify three ways to distribute business documents within a business.

45. List three possible reasons changes may need to be made to business documents which have already been produced.

46. Identify three considerations/activities involved when making required changes to business documents which have already been produced.

47. What does CC mean in relation to a business document?

48. Name four actions which must be observed/implemented as standard requirements when re-submitting a revised document.

49. Identify three common reasons/needs to file documents produced.

50. Identify four standard filing protocols.

51. List four actions which will enhance the security of computers used to generate/save electronic files/business documents.

Answers to written questions

Prepare business documents –D1.HGE.CL7.09 D1.HGA.CL6.06 D2.TGA.CL6.09

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. List three examples of business documents which may need to be produced.

- Reports
- Newsletters
- Submissions
- Proposals
- Project reviews
- Web pages
- Client data bases
- Tenders
- Complex letters
- Memos
- Agendas
- Minutes
- Project briefs
- Faxes
- Business and operational plans.

2. Explain the influence 'the audience' should have on the document produced.

- Documents should be written with the audience in mind
- The nature, tone, style and terminology used in documents should alter depending on the various audiences being addressed.

3. Name four factors which could influence the format of a business document.

- The template/pro forma used by the business
- Needs/wants of the person writing the document
- Needs of the client, document itself, audience, and/or enterprise practice
- Style Guide of the organisation.

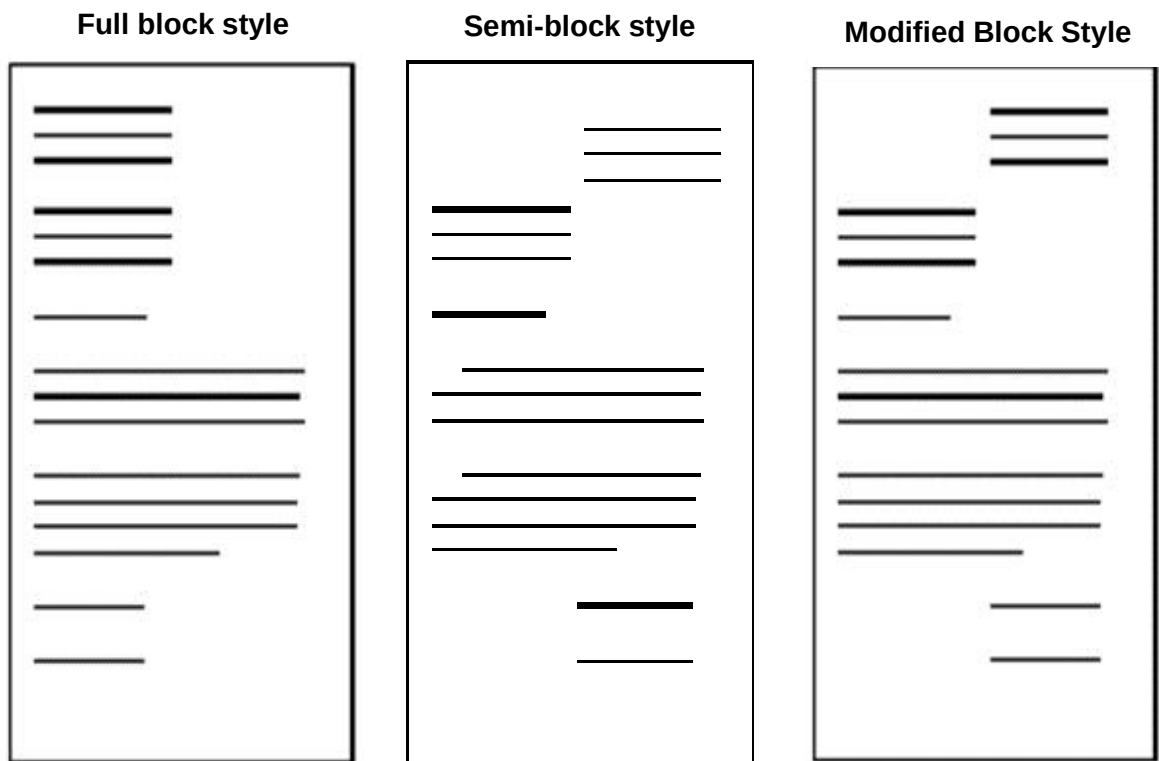
4. What is an organisational 'Style Guide'?

Organisational set of directions indicating format, style, layout etc. to be used in certain business documents produced by the organisation.

5. What are two aspects of 'fonts' which need to be considered when determining document requirements?

- Type face
- Size.

6. Identify the 'styles' for each of the following letters:



7. Describe three types of assistance those who produce business documents may obtain from copy writers and journalists.

- Advice on wording, phrasing and terminology used
- Advice on content
- Editing services
- Advice on openings/opportunities for media exposure for articles which have been produced.

8. Identify three classifications of people (apart from copy writers and journalists) from whom assistance may be sought by those who produce business documents.

- Researchers
- Designers
- Solicitors
- Accountants
- Colleagues with specialised expertise or experience m- trainers/assessors, supervisors/managers, health, safety and welfare officers
- Officers, inspectors or officials from various government bodies.

9. Describe four ways 'budget parameters' may/should impact the production of business documents.

It means there is a need to:

- Stay within the prescribed amounts
- Clarify exactly what the budget allowance entitles and does not entitle – budgets obviously include money but sometimes also allow for 'contra' deals where the business pays for services it receives by providing goods and services (meals, accommodation, trips and tours)
- Obtain quotations where charges are going to be incurred
- Compare quotations to obtain the best deal
- Use 'preferred suppliers/providers' wherever possible
- Get receipts for all monies spent
- Obtain approval before spending money
- Ask management permission to spend more if the budgeted parameters appear insufficient.

10. Give four reasons research may need to occur before a business document is written.

Research may be required to:

- Ensure the documents prepared effectively address their intended need
- Assemble the required material to form the content of the document
- Acquire current data, statistics, information and facts
- Obtain material to support or substantiate a case which is being made
- Make sure the information provided is honest and accurate
- Verify the response being provided by the organisation actually meets the needs of the person, body or organisation being written to
- Demonstrate professionalism in the execution of the work being done.

11. Differentiate between 'formal' and 'informal' research.

Formal research:

- Is structured research undertaken in a systematic manner designed to achieve one or more clearly defined objectives.
- Is a planned and controlled approach to capturing identified/required information or data which is objective in nature.
- A cost of some sort usually attaches to formal research.
- There is 'rigour' to formal research.

Informal research:

- Is unstructured and without the same intensity as formal research but it still has a focus which relates to the topic under consideration
- Tends to be uncontrolled (hence, somewhat 'random') and subjective in nature.
- Is often undertaken unintentionally and occurs 'by the way' as a result of doing something else
- Usually costs nothing (but time and effort)
- Is often not able to be substantiated or validated to the same extent formal research can be.

12. Give four examples of research methods which might be used for business documents.

- Conducting interviews
- Using focus groups
- Attending conferences and seminars
- Undertaking library research
- Researching government publications
- Doing Internet searches
- Reading relevant hard copy materials
- Applying surveys and questionnaires
- Doing internal research.

13. What is the difference between 'hard' research data and 'soft' research data'?

- Hard data = quantitative information: facts, figures, statistics
- Soft data = Qualitative information: information on why people do what they do.

14. Differentiate between 'secondary research data' and 'primary research data'.

- Secondary research data = information which already exists
- Primary research data = fresh/newly generated information.

15. List four activities that may be involved in the 'analysis and assessment' of research data.

- Checking data
- Testing data
- Evaluating information
- Summarising facts and figures
- Synthesising data
- Totalling and manipulating figures and data
- Drawing conclusions.

16. Name the four basic requirements that all research data used in business documents must comply with.

It must be:

- Accurate
- Current
- Verifiable
- Comprehensive.

17. Give examples of four things which should be ensured when identifying the key issues as they apply to a document being prepared.

- There is an understanding of what the organisation wants to achieve by preparing this document
- There is an understanding of what the recipient/s of this document want from this document
- All indicators for 'relevance' have been addressed and verified
- Key points of the document are highlighted
- The meaning of the document is clear to a reader
- Quality and quantity of information is appropriate to the needs of the document and the reader/s and/or user/s
- There are no obvious or deliberate omissions from the content
- Any decisions made within the document – or any recommendations/suggestions made – are supported by the evidence/content contained in the document.

18. Identify and differentiate between the four text alignment/justification options.

- Right aligned – where text aligns with right-hand side of page
- Left aligned – where text aligns with left-hand side of page
- Centred – where text aligns with middle of the page
- Justified – where text is auto-adjusted by the computer so sentences, regardless of length, align with both left and right margins to create a neat/clean look.

19. Identify four features of 'headers' and 'footers' which need to be determined when clarifying format requirements of a document.

- Font
- Size
- Use of borders and lines
- Structure and page numbering system
- Time and date as well as a file name identifier.

20. With reference to a letter, what is 'the closure'?

- Sometimes termed a 'complimentary close' this is the 'Yours faithfully' part of the letter.

21. What are the four standard sections of a short report?

- Introduction
- Main body
- Conclusion
- Recommendations.

22. What are the five basic software packages which exist?

- Word processing packages
- Spreadsheets
- Data bases
- E-mail packages
- Integrated packages.

23. What is the role of a 'modem'?

- To connect computers to the internet.

24. Give four basic text options when producing a business document.

- Italics
- Bold
- Underline
- Double underline
- Colour underline
- Single or double spacing of sentences
- Indents.

25. Give four examples of 'dot points'.

•	○	✓	▪	❖
---	---	---	---	---

26. List four reasons graphics might be used in a business document.

- Add interest and variety to the document
- Make a point
- Allow statistics to be better/easier understood
- Demonstrate a point
- Illustrate an item, product, service or facility.

27. Name four examples of graphics.

- Photographs
- Drawings and diagrams
- Maps
- Illustrations
- Cartoons
- Graphs, charts and tables.

28. List three important points to bear in mind when considering 'audiences' in the production of business documents.

- Deliberately/intentionally target them
- Write/speak at their level
- Use a relevant level of formality
- Avoid jargon where they may not know what it means
- Not use long/complicated words
- Take into account what they already know – and what they do not know
- Address what it is they want to know – or what the organisations wants to tell them/inform them about
- Respect them – in the tone and language used.

29. Approximately how many words should be in a sentence in a business document, and how many lines should there be in a paragraph?

- 15 words/sentence
- 7 lines/paragraph.

30. Give four examples of when/where there is/may be a need for the producer of a business document to make suggestions for changes.

- Where the client has required/demanded a specific style or type of response to their RFT, query, request for quotation or similar
- When there is an obvious error in the documentation provided
- If the draft document provided is overly-complicated in the way it is laid out and otherwise formatted – and a better, clearer option exists to facilitate understanding of the contents
- When a draft document lacks appeal and attractiveness
- Where the intended option for documentation appears to be an ineffective option
- When feedback has been received about standard form/template documents stating they are unhelpful, unacceptable, difficult to read or use
- When there has been a brand change of the organisation
- When the use of unacceptable language has been used.

31. What are the 'Seven C's in relation to the writing of business documents?

- Clear
- Concise
- Complete
- Correct
- Courteous
- Clean
- Checked.

32. What does TOC stand for?

- Table of Contents.

33. What is the role of a 'divider sheet'?

- To divide a document into sections.

34. Explain the difference between 'Footnotes' and 'End Notes'?

- Footnotes appear at the bottom of the page
- End notes appear at the end of the document.

35. Are 'Appendices' placed at the front or back of a document?

Back

36. List three ways documents may be bound or 'held together'.

- Using a ring binder
- Using a machine to spiral bind the document
- With staples
- Attaching clips.

37. Which paper size is twice the size of A4?

A3

38. How many sheets of paper in a ream?

500

39. What is the gsm rating/number for commonly used office paper?

70 – 100: 80

40. List three reasons adjustments may need to be made to business documents.

- Errors noted when working on the document
- Omissions identified as part of the drafting/preparation process
- The writing needs altering in some way – better options exist, spelling errors, poor grammar, incorrect punctuation
- The format or layout of the document just does not 'look right'
- Demand for the document to be revised to conform to non-negotiable requirements imposed by management or the organisational Style Guide
- Last minutes changes have been required.

41. What are the two generic ways of publishing a document?

- Printing them
- Sending/distributing them electronically.

42. What is meant by 'collating' a document?

Arranging the right pages/contents in the correct sequence

43. What is the role of a 'Distribution List'?

- To identify those to whom a document must be distributed
- To make sure only those on the List get a copy of the document.

44. Identify three ways to distribute business documents within a business.

- E-mail
- By hand
- Using pigeon holes
- Using internal memo envelopes.

45. List three possible reasons changes may need to be made to business documents which have already been produced.

- The document failed to meet/address the requirements of the recipient/user
- Circumstances have changed and the documents needs to be updated to reflect the current situation
- The recipient/user has changed their mind
- An error or omission has been identified and needs to be addressed/corrected
- As a result of the initial document the recipient/user has decided they want more or different information provided to them.

46. Identify three considerations/activities involved when making required changes to business documents which have already been produced.

- Take the time to ensure there is complete understanding of what is required
- Be prepared to contact the person/s who requested the changes for advice/clarification/more information
- Be willing to seek advice and help from others
- Apply the same protocols to the revision process as applied to the initial production process
- Keep a record/ copy of everything.

47. What does CC mean in relation to a business document?

- Carbon copy = names of those who have also received a copy of the document/letter/email.

48. Name four actions which must be observed/implemented as standard requirements when re-submitting a revised document.

- Be sure to meet the required deadlines which apply
- Check to verify the submission requirements
- Forward the revised document according to standard internal protocols
- Update file names
- Record provision of the revised document according to internal protocols
- Check with the relevant person to ensure all required changes have been made.

49. Identify three common reasons/needs to file documents produced.

- For future reference – if there is a need to clarify a detail/issue or address and resolve a misunderstanding/mistake
- To facilitate the production of other similar documents in the future – it is easier, quicker and less expensive to produce a document if there is another one on which to base it
- Compliance with legislated obligations – to maintain certain records in a given format for a nominated period.

50. Identify four standard filing protocols.

- Filing in alphabetical order
- Filing documents in numeric order – such as by Room Number
- Filing in date order
- Filing by location or department
- Filing by subject or topic.

51. List four actions which will enhance the security of computers used to generate/save electronic files/business documents.

- Regular back-up of data
 - Locking computers when not in use
 - Using password protection
 - Positioning screens so unauthorised people cannot see them
 - Closing screen when unauthorised people are present
 - Not sharing passwords
 - Changing passwords regularly
 - Restricting access to where computers are located
 - Running anti-virus and protection software.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Prepare business documents D1.HGE.CL7.09 D1.HGA.CL6.06 D2.TGA.CL6.09
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Determine document requirements - Conduct research - Prepare document - Follow up document - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Determine document requirement		
Define clearly the requirements for documents including purpose, audience, format, style, content and scope in consultation with relevant others	☐	☐
Obtain specialist assistance, where appropriate, within budget parameters	☐	☐
Element 2: Conduct research		
Conduct research according to the requirements of the document, using informal and formal data collection methods as appropriate	☐	☐
Analyse and assess data for relevance prior to incorporation into document, identifying key issues	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 3: Prepare document		
Write the document, using a suitable format, structure and style in accordance with requirements	☐	☐
Select and use appropriate technology and software for the requirements	☐	☐
Use a range of written presentation and graphic techniques to enhance the impact and effectiveness of the information presented	☐	☐
Use language and style appropriate to the document and intended audience, ensuring clarity of information and ease of reading	☐	☐
Make recommendations for action where appropriate	☐	☐
Review and check document presentation prior to finalization to ensure it is accurate, free from spelling and typing errors, and meets all requirements	☐	☐
Adjust where necessary, and seek advice or comment from relevant others, where appropriate	☐	☐
Publish the document in a format and style appropriate for the intended audience and purpose, and according to enterprise guidelines	☐	☐
Element 4: Follow up document		
Present and circulate documents for comment as appropriate	☐	☐
Respond to any feedback and comments received, and adjust document where required	☐	☐
Submit document to relevant persons as appropriate	☐	☐
Maintain and file copies of all documents within a secure and ordered system, according to enterprise practices	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other <i>Please specify: _____</i> <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Prepare business documents D1.HGE.CL7.09 D1.HGA.CL6.06 D2.TGA.CL6.09		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Defines document requirements and limitations on production	☐	☐	☐
Researches, analyses and assesses data/information for inclusion into documents	☐	☐	☐
Uses technology to write documents using appropriate format, style, structure, language and written and graphic presentation techniques	☐	☐	☐
Checks spelling, grammar, punctuation and other requirements for accuracy/correctness	☐	☐	☐
Prepares draft versions forwarding them for feedback and revising as required	☐	☐	☐
Produces final/approved documents and circulates/forwards as required	☐	☐	☐
Files and maintains copies of documents for future reference	☐	☐	☐
Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:			

Third party signature:	
Date:	
Send to:	

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student			
Name of Assessor/s			
Unit of Competency	Prepare business documents	D1.HGE.CL7.09	D1.HGA.CL6.06 D2.TGA.CL6.09
Date assessment commenced			
Date assessment finalised			
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)		
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)			
Comments/observations by assessor/s			

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Determine document requirements						
Define clearly the requirements for documents including purpose, audience, format, style, content and scope in consultation with relevant others						
Obtain specialist assistance, where appropriate, within budget parameters						
Element 2: Conduct research						
Define clearly the requirements for documents including purpose, audience, format, style, content and scope in consultation with relevant others						
Obtain specialist assistance, where appropriate, within budget parameters						
Element 3: Prepare document						
Write the document, using a suitable format, structure and style in accordance with requirements						
Select and use appropriate technology and software for the requirements						
Use a range of written presentation and graphic techniques to enhance the impact and effectiveness of the information presented						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Use language and style appropriate to the document and intended audience, ensuring clarity of information and ease of reading						
Make recommendations for action where appropriate						
Review and check document presentation prior to finalization to ensure it is accurate, free from spelling and typing errors, and meets all requirements						
Adjust where necessary, and seek advice or comment from relevant others, where appropriate						
Publish the document in a format and style appropriate for the intended audience and purpose, and according to enterprise guidelines						
Element 4: Follow up document						
Present and circulate documents for comment as appropriate						
Respond to any feedback and comments received, and adjust document where required						
Submit document to relevant persons as appropriate						
Maintain and file copies of all documents within a secure and ordered system, according to enterprise practices						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

